WEEK 11: VALUES CLARIFICATION - DEFINING SEXUAL INTEGRITY

Values vs. Goals

Before we dive into values work, it's critical to understand the difference between values and goals.

GOALS are destinations. They can be achieved or completed.

- "Get married"
- "Stay sober for 90 days"
- "Get a promotion"
- "Lose 20 pounds"

VALUES are directions. They're ongoing and never "finished."

- "Being a loving partner"
- "Living with integrity"
- "Growing in my career"
- "Taking care of my health"

THE KEY DIFFERENCES:

GOALS	VALUES
Destinations	Directions
Can be completed	Ongoing, never finished
"Get to California"	"Head west"
External validation	Internal meaning
Can be achieved by others	Uniquely personal
"I'll be happy when I achieve this"	"This is what makes life meaningful"

Example:

- **Goal:** "Stop looking at pornography for 6 months"
- **Value:** "Living with sexual integrity"

The goal can be achieved. The value is a lifelong direction. Even after 6 months without pornography, you're still *becoming* more aligned with sexual integrity. It never ends—and that's the point.

What Are Values?

Values are:

- Chosen directions for your life
- What you want your life to be about
- What matters most to you
- How you want to show up in the world
- Intrinsically motivated (they feel meaningful in themselves)

Values are NOT:

- Rules someone else imposed on you
- Things you think you "should" value
- Goals with finish lines
- Achievements or accomplishments
- Ways to please others or avoid judgment

CHARACTERISTICS OF TRUE VALUES:

1. CHOSEN You select them freely, not because someone told you to.

2. ONGOING They're never "done"—you can always move further in that direction.

3. INTRINSICALLY MEANINGFUL They matter to you for their own sake, not as a means to an end.

4. GUIDE BEHAVIOR They inform your choices and actions.

5. PERSONALLY SIGNIFICANT They reflect what YOU care about, not what others say you should care about.

Life Domains

Values show up across different areas of your life. Here are the key domains:

1. INTIMATE RELATIONSHIPS How do you want to be as a partner? What kind of connection do you want?

2. FAMILY RELATIONSHIPS How do you want to show up as a son, father, brother, uncle?

3. FRIENDSHIPS What kind of friend do you want to be? What do friendships mean to you?

4. WORK/CAREER What do you want your work to be about? How do you want to contribute?

5. PERSONAL GROWTH/LEARNING What does growth mean to you? How do you want to keep developing?

6. RECREATION/LEISURE How do you want to spend your free time? What brings you joy?

7. SPIRITUALITY What role does the sacred, transcendent, or meaningful play in your life?

8. COMMUNITY/CITIZENSHIP How do you want to contribute to something bigger than yourself?

9. PHYSICAL HEALTH How do you want to care for your body and wellbeing?

10. SEXUAL INTEGRITY How do you want your sexuality to align with your deepest values?

EXERCISE 1: VALUES EXPLORATION BY DOMAIN

For each domain, answer: "In this area of my life, what matters most to me?"

INTIMATE RELATIONSHIPS:

What kind of partner do I want to be?

_____

_____

What values guide my intimate relationships?

_____

_____

_____

FAMILY RELATIONSHIPS:

What kind of son/father/brother do I want to be?

_____

_____

What values are most important in my family life?

_____

FRIENDSHIPS:

What kind of friend do I want to be?

What do I value most in friendships?

WORK/CAREER:

What do I want my work to be about?

What values guide my professional life?

PERSONAL GROWTH/LEARNING:

How do I want to keep growing and developing?

What values drive my desire to learn and improve?

RECREATION/LEISURE:

How do I want to experience joy and rest?

What values are present when I'm at my best in leisure?

SPIRITUALITY:

What gives my life meaning beyond the material?

What spiritual values matter to me?

COMMUNITY/CITIZENSHIP:

How do I want to contribute to something larger than myself?

What values guide my sense of social responsibility?

PHYSICAL HEALTH:

How do I want to care for my body?

What values underlie my approach to health?

SEXUAL INTEGRITY:

How do I want my sexuality to be expressed?

What values guide my sexual choices?

Common Values List

Here's a list of common values to help you identify yours. Circle or check the ones that resonate most deeply.

CONNECTION & RELATIONSHIPS:

- ☐ Love
- ☐ Intimacy
- ☐ Connection
- ☐ Trust
- ☐ Loyalty
- ☐ Friendship
- ☐ Family
- ☐ Belonging

PERSONAL QUALITIES:

- ☐ Integrity
- ☐ Honesty
- ☐ Authenticity
- ☐ Courage
- ☐ Humility
- ☐ Compassion
- ☐ Kindness
- ☐ Patience

GROWTH & DEVELOPMENT:

- ☐ Learning
- ☐ Growth
- ☐ Wisdom
- ☐ Curiosity

- [ ] Self-awareness
- [ ] Excellence
- [ ] Mastery
- [ ] Challenge

CONTRIBUTION:

- [ ] Service
- [ ] Generosity
- [ ] Justice
- [ ] Fairness
- [ ] Leadership
- [ ] Mentoring
- [ ] Making a difference
- [ ] Legacy

FREEDOM & AUTONOMY:

- [ ] Independence
- [ ] Freedom
- [ ] Self-determination
- [ ] Adventure
- [ ] Exploration
- [ ] Risk-taking
- [ ] Spontaneity
- [ ] Flexibility

STABILITY & SECURITY:

- [ ] Stability
- [ ] Safety
- [ ] Order
- [ ] Responsibility
- [ ] Dependability
- [ ] Commitment
- [ ] Tradition
- [ ] Structure

PLEASURE & JOY:

- [ ] Fun
- [ ] Pleasure

- [ ] Joy
- [ ] Beauty
- [ ] Creativity
- [ ] Playfulness
- [ ] Humor
- [ ] Sensuality

MEANING & PURPOSE:

- [ ] Purpose
- [ ] Meaning
- [ ] Spirituality
- [ ] Faith
- [ ] Contribution
- [ ] Transcendence
- [ ] Legacy
- [ ] Impact

HEALTH & VITALITY:

- [ ] Health
- [ ] Vitality
- [ ] Fitness
- [ ] Energy
- [ ] Mindfulness
- [ ] Balance
- [ ] Self-care
- [ ] Wellbeing

Other values important to you:

_____

_____

_____

_____

EXERCISE 2: MY TOP 10 VALUES

From the list above and your domain exploration, identify your **top 10 core values**—the ones that matter most across all areas of your life.

Rank them in order of importance:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

6. _____

7. _____

8. _____

9. _____

10. _____

Now narrow it to your TOP 3-5 VALUES:

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

Sexual Integrity: Defining It for Yourself

Back in Week 1, you started defining what sexual integrity means to you. Now, with a deeper understanding of your values, it's time to refine that definition.

Sexual integrity is NOT:

- Abstinence (unless that's what you choose)
- Following someone else's rules
- Never having sexual thoughts
- Being perfect
- Shame-free sexuality (shame will arise; integrity is how you respond)

Sexual integrity IS:

- Aligning sexual expression with YOUR values
- Acting from choice rather than compulsion
- Being honest with yourself and others
- Sexuality that enhances life rather than damages it
- Consistency between your values and your actions

EXERCISE 3: MY DEFINITION OF SEXUAL INTEGRITY

Based on my values, sexual integrity means:

_____

_____

_____

_____

_____

Living with sexual integrity would look like:

In my intimate relationship:

_____

_____

In my relationship with myself:

_____

_____

In my daily choices:

_____

_____

Sexual integrity is present when I:

_____

_____

_____

Sexual integrity is violated when I:

Values-Behavior Gap Analysis

Now comes the hard part: looking honestly at the gap between your values and your current behavior.

The gap is not a source of shame—it's information.

Everyone has a values-behavior gap. The question is: Are you willing to face it and work to close it?

EXERCISE 4: VALUES-BEHAVIOR GAP ANALYSIS

For each of your top 5 values, assess the current gap:

VALUE #1: _____

On a scale of 1-10, how aligned is my behavior with this value currently?

1 = Completely misaligned | 10 = Fully aligned

Current alignment: _____/10

Where am I living this value well?

Where is there a gap?

How does my sexual behavior impact this value?

One small action I can take this week to close the gap:

VALUE #2: _____

Current alignment: _____/10

Where am I living this value well?

_____

_____

Where is there a gap?

_____

_____

How does my sexual behavior impact this value?

_____

_____

One small action I can take this week to close the gap:

_____

_____

_____

VALUE #3: _____

Current alignment: _____/10

Where am I living this value well?

_____

_____

Where is there a gap?

_____

_____

How does my sexual behavior impact this value?

_____

_____

One small action I can take this week to close the gap:

_____

_____

_____

VALUE #4: _____

Current alignment: _____/10

Where am I living this value well?

_____

_____

Where is there a gap?

_____

_____

How does my sexual behavior impact this value?

_____

_____

One small action I can take this week to close the gap:

_____

_____

_____

VALUE #5: _____

Current alignment: _____/10

Where am I living this value well?

_____

_____

Where is there a gap?

_____

_____

How does my sexual behavior impact this value?

_____

_____

One small action I can take this week to close the gap:

_____

_____

_____

The Power of Values-Guided Living

When you're clear about your values, decisions become easier.

Without values clarity:

- "Should I look at porn right now?" → Internal debate, willpower struggle

With values clarity:

- "Does this align with my value of integrity?" → Clear answer, values-guided choice

Values don't eliminate urges. They give you a compass for navigating them.

EXERCISE 5: VALUES REMINDER CARD

Create a card with your top 3-5 values that you can reference daily.

Cut this out or copy onto an index card:

MY CORE VALUES

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

When I'm faced with a decision, I ask:

"Does this choice align with my values?"

"What would the person I want to be do right now?"

"Am I moving toward or away from what matters most?"

Values in Action This Week

This week, commit to ONE values-aligned action in each of these areas:

In my intimate relationship (or future relationship):

In my relationship with myself:

In my recovery:

At work:

In my health:

DAILY MONITORING LOG - WEEK 11

Continue your daily monitoring. This week, add focus on values alignment.

Additional tracking:

- What values-aligned actions did I take?
- When did I act against my values?
- How did values-guided choices feel different?

[7 daily logs with same format as previous weeks—see Appendix A for blank forms]

WEEK 11 HOMEWORK CHECKLIST

Before moving to Week 12, complete:

- [ ] Read all Week 11 material
- [ ] Complete values exploration by domain
- [ ] Identify top 10 values, then narrow to top 3-5
- [ ] Write my personal definition of sexual integrity
- [ ] Complete values-behavior gap analysis for all 5 top values
- [ ] Create values reminder card (carry it with you)
- [ ] Take one values-aligned action in each area this week
- [ ] Complete daily monitoring logs for all 7 days
- [ ] Notice: When do I feel most aligned with my values? When do I drift?

Notes for Week 11:

END OF WEEK 11